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THE LAST PANEL

A Comic-Driven Mystery Puzzle Adventure

GAME JAM EVALUATION SUMMARY

One-line pitch: Aarav follows a trail of comic-book riddles to find his missing sister, only to discover that the puzzles were never about finding her—they were designed to control where he goes.

Genre Mystery • Puzzle • Adventure	Core Themes Comic • Light Humor • Suspense • Manipulation
Player Role Aarav, a 19-year-old puzzle-loving student	Primary Goal Follow clues, solve puzzles and uncover who is controlling the game

STORY SETUP

The game opens in high school with a serious argument between Aarav and his close friend Vihaan. The reason for their conflict is deliberately hidden. That evening, Aarav reaches home and discovers that his younger sister Meera is missing. Her phone is still on the table, the front door is unlocked, and there are no signs of a struggle.

On the table is one of Aarav's favorite comic books. Inside it is a handwritten message: “**You love riddles, don't you? Let's play one last game. Find your sister.**” A mysterious symbol appears below the message. Aarav immediately suspects Vihaan and follows the clues.

THE PLAYER'S JOURNEY

01 • FOLLOW THE PANELS Comic panels contain riddles leading Aarav through the school, library, old theatre, railway station, abandoned road and finally a forest.	02 • FOREST ROOM A hidden room is covered with comic pages, locked boxes and keys. Aarav solves a chain of puzzles believing it will lead him to Meera.
03 • THE DISTRACTION After the final key is found, Aarav discovers that the room contained no route to Meera. A message reveals the puzzles were only a timed distraction.	04 • THE REAL QUESTION The player realizes the riddles were not testing Aarav's intelligence. They were directing his path and controlling exactly where he would go.

CHARACTERS

AARAV — 19 Cheerful, energetic and clever. He loves comic books, riddles and anything mysterious. His curiosity often makes him rush into situations.	VIHAAN — 19 Aarav's wealthy, calm and mysterious classmate and close friend. He knows more about the situation than he reveals.	MEERA — 15–16 Aarav's intelligent, observant and playful younger sister. Her disappearance is the mystery that drives the chapter.
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THE LAST PANEL

Gameplay Mechanics • Light/Comic Identity • Major Twists • Chapter Ending

LEVEL 2 — THE WHITE ROOM

Aarav escapes the forest room and enters a huge white room with no visible doors or furniture. A circular object hangs from the ceiling. A countdown begins: **5 • 4 • 3 • 2 • 1**. A VIBGYOR color sequence flashes across the wall, followed by a bright flash. The message “**Remember.**” appears.

Memory Puzzle: The player must reproduce the exact color sequence. A correct answer progresses the challenge. A wrong answer triggers a beep and causes the walls to move inward, increasing pressure and making every mistake meaningful.

LEVEL 3 — THE ROOM LEARNS

The puzzle becomes progressively harder. Colors may appear in a new order, only some colors may be shown, or a color may flash twice. The player must remember the complete sequence while the shrinking room creates tension. The environment therefore acts as both the puzzle and the threat.

THE BIG REVEAL

When Aarav completes the color puzzle, a hidden corridor opens. Instead of finding Meera, he discovers a wall covered with photographs of Aarav, Meera, Vihaan, the school, the forest and the rooms he has already visited. The most disturbing photograph shows Aarav entering the forest room—even though it was taken before he arrived.

Aarav: “Who knew I was coming?”

FINAL REVEAL — CHAPTER 1 ENDING

A screen turns on and Vihaan appears. He is not laughing or celebrating; he looks genuinely worried. Aarav demands to know where Meera is.

Vihaan: “Aarav... I never wanted you to come this far.”

Aarav: “Where is my sister?”

Vihaan: “She was never the target.”

“You were.”

WHY THE IDEA STANDS OUT

COMIC IS PART OF GAMEPLAY Comic pages are not just decoration. Panels contain clues, hide information and visually reveal story changes.	LIGHT CREATES GAMEPLAY The color-memory room makes light and color an active puzzle mechanic rather than a simple visual effect.
PUZZLES SERVE THE STORY The player's actions have narrative meaning: solving the riddles unknowingly helps the mastermind control Aarav's route.	LIGHT HUMOR + SUSPENSE Aarav's personality provides comic relief without removing the mystery. Example: “Definitely a completely normal Tuesday.”

PLAYER PROMISE: Every clue should make the player feel smarter, every twist should make them rethink what they already saw, and every comic panel should raise a new question. The chapter ends before the full truth is revealed, creating a clear foundation for future chapters.

FINAL TITLE CARD

THE GAME HAS JUST BEGUN.